

RIAs AND MOBILE APPS

Latest trends indicate a leaning towards mobile computing. RIAs offer an effective way to cater to the tablet-savvy consumer...

Rich Internet Applications

RIAs or Rich Internet Applications are web applications that work like full-fledged desktop applications in many ways. They are delivered to the user through a site specific browser either through a plug in or virtual machines. A site-specific browser is a browser minus the menu and controls.

With more and more services moving to the cloud and with increased internet connectivity among mobile devices RIAs are becoming increasingly popular on desktops as well as mobile devices. RIAs provide robust ways of interacting with the users with better efficiency than ever before. Consider traditional applications which generally tend to be limited to form fields, radio buttons, and check boxes. In contrast, RIAs let you perform in-line editing, drag and drop items or otherwise interact directly with the elements. Popular browser based RIAs include Flickr, Google Maps, and eBay.

Adobe describes an RIA as a lightweight application with a subset of the functionality and feature set of a desktop application while the user interface